Jonathan Tollefson

Design Engineer

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SUMMARY

Five years across marketing, UX, and enterprise data. I now build what I design: front-end, audio tools, and applied AI. My job doesn't pay me to build these. But I use them every day.

EXPERIENCE

Own products · Design Engineer — 2026 – Present

- A catch-all agent (Intake) that turns a voice memo or a text to myself into calendar and reminder changes, or a ticket for me to judge. Python, SQLite, Whisper, Claude.
- An audio catalog (AudioDex), about 20,000 recordings transcribed, fingerprinted, deduplicated and classified by a Python pipeline (Whisper, librosa, Claude), searchable by a word from a phone app in TypeScript.
- A browser instrument (SIGNAL) on my homepage, drums, bass and keys under the computer keyboard; it records a visitor's take as a WAV. TypeScript, Web Audio.
- A browser studio (Signal Studio) in TypeScript and Web Audio. One click samples any instrument I own; it detects tempo and key and prints the loops as stems. I stopped opening Ableton.
- An AI mastering agent that masters a mix in a stateful, multi-step run, rendering candidates through FabFilter plugins and judging them blind, loudness-matched, against the untouched original. Python, pedalboard, Claude.

uxjon.com/case-studies/the-console

CHS Inc. · Business Analyst, AI & BI Engineering — Aug 2023 – Present

- Built agents on the company's internal AI platform, then designed and wrote the docs, guides and onboarding chat for its 10,000 employees; other internal tools are adopting the design system.
- Built a Python tool that writes each dbt model's lineage to Excel, Power BI, and stakeholder briefs in one pass.
- Coordinate releases for the go-to-market data engineering team; used AI to find data models missing semantic context and added it in Alation with their developers.

Raylu, Inc. · Product Designer (Freelance) — Jan 2023 – Oct 2023

- Designed the brand, components, and prototypes for an AI startup; the founders carried them into meetings that closed a $4M seed, and engineers built from the same file.

Crediverso · UX Design Lead — Feb 2021 – Jan 2023

- Led the design system and onboarding for a bilingual banking app on iOS; after usability tests with 50+ participants, the revised main flow cut bounce from 40% to 25%.

EDUCATION

Harvard University — 2022
A.B. in Sociology, secondary field in History of Science

University of Minnesota — 2016 – 2018
Transfer years; returned to Harvard to graduate

SKILLS

Build: TypeScript, React, Astro, Vite, HTML, CSS, Node, Python, FastAPI, SQL
Audio and AI: Web Audio API, Web MIDI, Claude API, Claude Code, Whisper, librosa, demucs, pedalboard
Design and data: Figma, Framer, Adobe Creative Suite, dbt, Snowflake, Power BI, Alation